

▲ Bajra



▲ Jowar



▲ Fruits



▲ Honey



▲ Jaggery

5.2.2 Proteins:

- **Definition**

  The word '**protein**' is derived from the Greek word protos meaning 'first'. Protein is the basic chemical unit of living organisms and is essential for nutrition, building of new tissues (growth) and maintaining and repairing of those already built. Casein from milk, albumin in egg and gluten in wheat, are examples of proteins occurring in foods.

- **Classification:** The proteins are classified as:
  - Complete proteins e.g. Egg proteins
  - Partially complete proteins e.g. wheat proteins
  - Incomplete proteins e.g. Gelatin or zein

- **Functions**: Proteins perform the following functions;
  - Necessary for growth
  - Wear and tear of human body is repaired
  - For regular supply of raw materials for the formation of digestive juices, hormones, plasma proteins, hemoglobin, vitamins and enzymes.

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